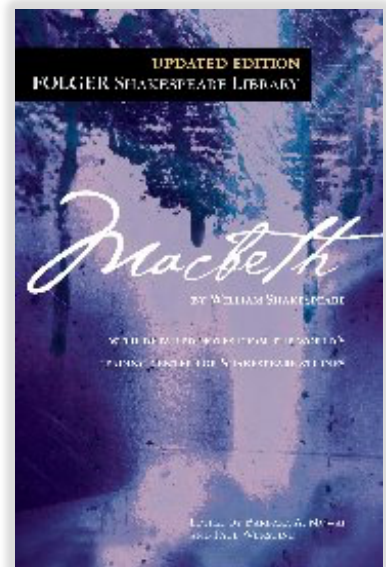
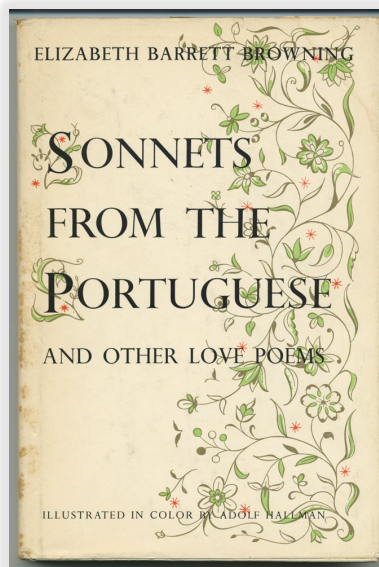
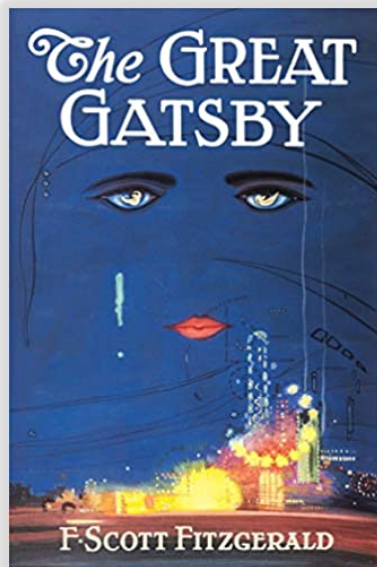




UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Literary Criticism

District • 2022



DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District • 2022

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History

30 items (1 point each)

1. The pattern in which the second part of a verse line or grammatical structure is balanced against the first part but with the parts reversed is an example of
 - A) antithesis.
 - B) apposition.
 - C) chiasmus.
 - D) parallelism.
 - E) reduplication.
2. The quality in art and literature that stimulates pity, tenderness, or sorrow is
 - A) bathos.
 - B) ethos.
 - C) logos.
 - D) mythos.
 - E) pathos.
3. Awarded "for his important achievement both in [. . .] lyrical poetry and in the field of the great Russian epic tradition, "the recipient of the 1958 Nobel Prize for Literature (though he was forced to decline it) is
 - A) Svetlana Alexievich.
 - B) Joseph Brodsky.
 - C) Ivan A. Bunin.
 - D) Boris Pasternak.
 - E) Mikhail A. Sholokhov.
4. The not necessarily witting or even necessary misstep, frailty, mistaken judgment, or error through which the fortunes of a tragic hero are reversed is known as
 - A) catharsis.
 - B) hamartia.
 - C) hubris.
 - D) reification.
 - E) stichomythia.
5. The body of English drama produced during the century preceding the closing of the theaters in 1642 is known as
 - A) boulevard drama.
 - B) Elizabethan drama.
 - C) medieval drama.
 - D) Restoration drama.
 - E) tragedy of blood.
6. The period of American literature in which Benjamin Franklin, Anne Bradstreet, and Jonathan Edwards flourished as authors is called the
 - A) Colonial Period.
 - B) Postmodern Period.
 - C) Realistic Period.
 - D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
 - E) Romantic Period.
7. The genre of fiction describing an imaginary ideal world is known as
 - A) dystopian.
 - B) ecotopian.
 - C) ectopian.
 - D) subtopian.
 - E) utopian.
8. **Not** the eighteenth- or nineteenth-century literary period in which historical and religious concerns, **or** the romantic spirit, **or** pragmatic verisimilitude characterizes the literature is the
 - A) Colonial Period.
 - B) Period of the Confessional Self.
 - C) Realistic Period.
 - D) Revolutionary Period.
 - E) Romantic Period.
9. A mistake in terms of a badly formed word that results from the violation of an accepted rule of linguistic morphology, such as *goodest* for *best*, *hern* for *hers*, and *clomb* for *climbed*, is called a
 - A) barbarism.
 - B) Gongorism.
 - C) Malapropism.
 - D) Spoonerism.
 - E) Wellerism.
10. The former United States Poet Laureate (2017-2019) whose collection *Life on Mars* earned her the 2012 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry is
 - A) Gwendolyn Brooks.
 - B) Rita Dove.
 - C) Louise Glück.
 - D) Tracy K. Smith.
 - E) Natasha Trethewey.

11. The fixed nineteen-line form, originally French but used more by Anglophone poets, employing only two rhymes and repeating two of the lines according to the set pattern *abá aba abá aba abá*, concluding *abaá*, is the
 - A) cinquain.
 - B) pantoum.
 - C) rondeau.
 - D) *terza rima*.
 - E) villanelle.
12. The American playwright "born in a hotel room and died in a hotel room" who received Pulitzer Prizes for his *Beyond the Horizon*, *Anna Christie*, *Strange Interlude*, and *Long Day's Journey into Night* is
 - A) Edward Albee.
 - B) Horton Foote.
 - C) David Mamet.
 - D) Eugene O'Neill.
 - E) Tennessee Williams.
13. A narrative or tradition handed down from the past that is characterized by having something of the historical truth and relatively little of the supernatural is called (a/an)
 - A) anecdote.
 - B) folklore.
 - C) legend.
 - D) myth.
 - E) parable.
14. **Not** a form of poetry considered to be a pattern poem is the
 - A) altar poem.
 - B) *carmen figuratum*.
 - C) figure poem.
 - D) rebus.
 - E) shaped verse.
15. A term associated with highly affected styles of writing that exhibit stylistic extravagances including neologism, innovations in grammar, bombast, paradoxes, conceits, puns, and obscurity is
 - A) Gongorism.
 - B) Malapropism.
 - C) Orphism.
 - D) Spoonerism.
 - E) Wellerism.
16. The nineteenth-century English author of *Adam Bede*, *Silas Marner*, *The Mill on the Floss*, *Mid-dlemarch*, *Daniel Deronda*, *Romola*, and *Felix Holt, the Radical* and translator of Ludwig Feuerbach's *Das Wesen des Christentums* is
 - A) George Eliot.
 - B) Rudyard Kipling.
 - C) Thomas Babington Macaulay.
 - D) William Makepeace Thackeray.
 - E) Anthony Trollope.
17. The philosophy founded by Zeno in the fourth century BCE that exalts endurance and self-sufficiency and that, in Hemingway's words, can be recognized as "grace under pressure" is
 - A) Calvinism.
 - B) Gnosticism.
 - C) Philistinism.
 - D) Stoicism.
 - E) Transcendentalism.
18. The twentieth-century author of *In Our Time*, *The Sun Also Rises*, *A Farewell to Arms*, *To Have and Have Not*, *For Whom the Bell Tolls*, and *The Old Man and the Sea* is
 - A) John Cheever.
 - B) William Faulkner.
 - C) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
 - D) Ernest Hemingway.
 - E) John Steinbeck.
19. The nineteenth-century American author of *Uncle Tom's Cabin* and *The Minister's Wooing* is
 - A) Louisa May Alcott.
 - B) Kate Chopin.
 - C) Emily Dickinson.
 - D) Margaret Fuller.
 - E) Harriet Beecher Stowe.
20. The time in English literature between the period during which French was the language of English court life and the appearance of Modern English writings is known as the
 - A) Anglo-Saxon Period.
 - B) Jacobean Age.
 - C) Middle English Period.
 - D) Old English Period.
 - E) Renaissance.

21. An interlude in which a drama's actors freeze in position and then resume action as before or hold their positions until the curtain falls is (a/n)
A) establishing shot.
B) hiatus.
C) macrosegment.
D) suspense.
E) tableau.
22. The most popular form of theater in Japan since the mid-seventeenth century, one characterized by a combination of dance and musical theatre is
A) haiku.
B) kabuki.
C) noh.
D) senryu.
E) tanka.
23. The term that embodies the application of principles of scientific (either biological or socioeconomic) determinism in literature, which, in turn, characterizes a literary movement of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, is
A) dandyism.
B) Darwinism.
C) meliorism.
D) naturalism.
E) objectivism.
24. **Not** among the famous Elizabethan Age revenge tragedies, some of which are also known as tragedies of blood, is
A) Thomas Kyd's *The Spanish Tragedy*.
B) John Marston's *Antonio's Revenge*.
C) Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Hamlet*.
D) Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Macbeth*.
E) Shakespeare's *Titus Andronicus*.
25. The eighteenth-century author of the first book-length novel in English, *The History of the Adventures of Joseph Andrews and of his Friend Mr. Abraham Adams*, as well as the picaresque novel *The History of Tom Jones, a Foundling*, is
A) Henry Fielding.
B) Oliver Goldsmith.
C) Samuel Johnson.
D) Samuel Richardson.
E) Laurence Sterne.
26. The formulaic use of language—usually spoken or chanted—either to create intense emotional effects or to produce magical results is called a(n)
A) apostrophe.
B) encomium.
C) incantation.
D) kenning.
E) transferred epithet.
27. The term used by Gerard Manley Hopkins for the "individually distinctive" inner structure or nature of a thing—the essence of a natural object—is
A) counterpoint.
B) cynghanedd.
C) inscape.
D) instress.
E) outride.
28. The group of late-nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century writers, principally in France but also in England and America, who held that art is superior to nature and that the finest beauty is that of dying and decaying things is the
A) Aesthetes.
B) Decadents.
C) Imagists.
D) Parnassians.
E) Physiocrats.
29. The author of *Sophie's Choice* who received the Pulitzer Prize for Fiction in 1968 for his controversial *The Confessions of Nat Turner* is
A) John Cheever.
B) MacKinlay Kantor.
C) Bernard Malamud.
D) Conrad Richter.
E) William Styron.
30. The term applied to the group of twentieth-century writers in the American South who published the little magazine *The Fugitive*, which championed Southern regionalism, and who founded the New Criticism movement is
A) Agrarians.
B) Hartford Wits.
C) Lollards.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Muckrakers.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List

20 items (2 points each)

Items 31-36 are associated with William Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Macbeth*.

Items 37-42 are associated with F. Scott Fitzgerald's *The Great Gatsby*.

Items 43-50 are associated with Elizabeth Barrett Browning's poetry (selected).

31. In Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Macbeth*, the insightfully prophetic observation "But 'tis strange. / And oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths, / Win us with honest trifles, to betray 's / In deepest consequence" is spoken by
 - A) Banquo.
 - B) Donalbain.
 - C) Hecate.
 - D) Macbeth.
 - E) Malcolm.
32. "Were I from Dunsinane away and clear, / Profit again should hardly draw me here" reflects the concerns of
 - A) the Captain.
 - B) the Doctor.
 - C) the Gentlewoman.
 - D) the Porter.
 - E) the Third Murderer.
33. The curiously hyperbolic "Safe in a ditch he bides, / With twenty trenchèd gashes on his head, / The least a death to nature" serves as a report on the murder of
 - A) Banquo.
 - B) Donalbain.
 - C) Duncan.
 - D) Fleance.
 - E) Malcolm.
34. Macbeth's arrogance, summed up in the threat, "I will be satisfied. Deny me this, / And an eternal curse fall on you!" is directed toward (the)
 - A) Apparitions.
 - B) Banquo.
 - C) Hecate.
 - D) Murderers.
 - E) Witches.
35. "Your eye in Scotland / Would create soldiers, make our women fight / To doff their dire distresses" summarizes a petition delivered by
 - A) Angus to Banquo.
 - B) Fleance to Macbeth.
 - C) Lennox to Duncan.
 - D) Ross to Malcom.
 - E) Seyton to Donalbain.
36. The guilt coloring the hypophoric "Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand? No, this my hand will rather / The multitudinous seas incarnadine, / Making the green one red" reveals a level of awareness on the part of
 - A) Duncan.
 - B) the Gentlewoman.
 - C) Lady Macbeth.
 - D) Macbeth.
 - E) Malcolm.
37. In Fitzgerald's *The Great Gatsby*, **not** actually one of Chester McKee's several photographic prints is
 - A) "Beauty and the Beast."
 - B) "Brook'n Bridge."
 - C) "George B. Wilson at the Gasoline Pump."
 - D) "Montauk Point—The Gulls."
 - E) "Old Grocery Horse."
38. The revelatory disclosure "I wanted no more riotous excursions with privileged glimpses into the human heart" is shared by
 - A) Tom Buchanan.
 - B) Nick Carraway.
 - C) Jay Gatsby.
 - D) Henry C. Gatz.
 - E) George B. Wilson.
39. Nick concludes that Tom, Gatsby, Daisy, Jordan, and he possess "some deficiency in common" because they are all
 - A) East Eggers.
 - B) equestrians.
 - C) nouveau riche.
 - D) West Eggers.
 - E) Westerners.
40. "He owned some drug-stores, a lot of drug-stores. He built them up himself" is the explanation for Gatsby's wealth offered by
 - A) Catherine.
 - B) Daisy.
 - C) Jordan.
 - D) Myrtle.
 - E) Pammy.

41. The narrator's account, "A succulent hash arrived, and Mr. Wolfshiem, forgetting the more sentimental atmosphere of the old Metropole, began to eat with ferocious delicacy," relies on (a/an)
- antithesis.
 - litotes.
 - oxymoron.
 - paradox.
 - tautology.
42. Carraway's casual assertion, "This is an unusual party for me. I haven't even seen the host. I live over there [. . .] and this man Gatsby sent over his chauffeur with an invitation," is directed at
- Buchanan.
 - Gatsby.
 - Trimalchio.
 - Wilson.
 - Wolfshiem.
45. The concurrent response of two or more of the senses to the stimulation of one sense as exemplified by "silver answer rang" in the final line of Browning's sonnet is an occurrence of (a/n)
- chiaroscuro.
 - discordia concors.
 - enantiosis.
 - synæsthesia.
 - transferred epithet.
46. The continuance of both the grammatical structure and the semantic meaning of a line of verse in one stanza to a line in the next stanza as in Sonnet I's move from octave to sestet is called (a)
- chiasmus.
 - end-stopped line.
 - enjambment.
 - run-on line.
 - tagline.

Items 43-48 refer to Elizabeth Barrett Browning's

Sonnet I

I thought once how Theocritus had sung
 Of the sweet years, the dear and wished for years,
 Who each one in a gracious hand appears
 To bear a gift for mortals, old or young: 4
 And, as I mused it in his antique tongue,
 I saw, in gradual vision through my tears,
 The sweet, sad years, the melancholy years,
 Those of my own life, who by turns had flung 8
 A shadow across me. Straightway I was 'ware,
 So weeping, how a mystic Shape did move
 Behind me, and drew me backward by the hair;
 And a voice said in mastery, while I strove,— 12
 "Guess now who holds thee!"—"Death," I said.
 But, there,
 The silver answer rang, "Not Death, but Love."

43. Theocritus of EBB's Sonnet I is credited with creating
- Greek calendar years.
 - Greek erotic music.
 - Greek historical perspective.
 - Greek pastoral poetry.
 - Greek visionary mysticism.
44. The melopoeic repetition dominating lines 2 and 10 is
- assonance.
 - dissonance.
 - heteroglossia.
 - resonance.
 - sigmatism.

47. Line 9's dropping of the first unstressed syllable to form the word 'ware is an example of
- aphaeresis.
 - apocope.
 - ellipsis.
 - metathesis.
 - syncope.
48. Browning's Sonnet I best meets the expectations of a(n)
- Anglo-Norman sonnet.
 - English sonnet.
 - Italian sonnet.
 - Milonic sonnet.
 - Spenserian sonnet.

Items 49-50 refer to Elizabeth Barrett Browning's

A Lady's Yes

"Yes!" I answered you last night;
 "No!" this morning, Sir, I say!
 Colours, seen by candle-light,
 Will not look the same by day. 4

When the tabors played their best,
 Lamps above, and laughs below—
Love me sounded like a jest,
 Fit for *Yes* or fit for *No!* 8

Call me false, or call me free—
 Vow, whatever light may shine,
 No man on your face shall see
 Any grief for change on mine. 12

Yet the sin is on us both—
Time to dance is not to woo—
Wooer light makes fickle troth—
Scorn of *me* recoils on *you!* 16

Learn to win a lady's faith
Nobly, as the thing is high;
Bravely, as for life and death—
With a loyal gravity. 20

Lead her from the festive boards,
Point her to the starry skies,
Guard her, by your truthful words,
Pure from courtship's flatteries. 24

By your truth she shall be true—
Ever true, as wives of yore—
And her *Yes*, once said to you,
Shall be *Yes* for evermore. 28

49. The rhyme schemes of the fourth, fifth, and sixth stanzas of Browning's "A Lady's Yes" depend on

A) consonance.
B) dissonance.
C) resonance.
D) sigmatism.
E) syzygy.

50. Line 5's "tabors play[ing] their best" are

A) candles.
B) colours.
C) drums.
D) jests.
E) lovers.

51. Charles Tennyson Turner's closed-form poem comes closest to meeting the expectations of a(n)

A) Anglo-Norman sonnet.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearean sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. In line 7 the speaker credits nature—the bee—with human emotions, which is an example of

A) affective fallacy.
B) baring the device.
C) metafiction.
D) objective correlative.
E) pathetic fallacy.

53. The sonnet's couplet exhibits a set of strongly contrasting ideas that constitute (a/n)

A) ambiguity.
B) antithesis.
C) equivocate.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

54. Line 2's auditory imagery depends on

A) cacophony.
B) heteroglossia.
C) onomatopoeia.
D) sigmatism.
E) xenoglossia.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism

15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Charles Tennyson Turner's

Julius Cæsar and the Honey-bee

Poring on Cæsar's death with earnest eye,
I heard a fretful buzzing in the pane:
"Poor bee!" I cried, "I'll help thee by-and-by;"
Then dropp'd mine eyes upon the page again. 4
Alas! I did not rise; I help'd him not:
In the great voice of Roman history
I lost the pleading of the window-bee,
And all his woes and troubles were forgot. 8
In pity for the mighty chief, who bled
Beside his rival's statue, I delay'd
To serve the little insect's present need;
And so he died for lack of human aid. 12
I could not change the Roman's destiny;
I might have set the honey-maker free.

Items 55-56 refer to John F. Kennedy's
Address before the UN General Assembly

Mankind must put an end to war,
or war will put an end to mankind.

55. Excerpted, JFK's words take the form of a(n)

A) epigram.
B) epigraph.
C) epitaph.
D) epithet.
E) eponym.

56. The pithiness of JFK's admonition depends on

A) caesura.
B) chiasmus.
C) parallelism.
D) reduplication.
E) zeugma.

Items 57-60 refer to William Butler Yeats's

When You Are Old

When you are old and grey and full of sleep,
And nodding by the fire, take down this book,
And slowly read, and dream of the soft look
Your eyes had once, and of their shadows deep; 4

How many loved your moments of glad grace,
And loved your beauty with love false or true,
But one man loved the pilgrim soul in you,
And loved the sorrows of your changing face; 8

And bending down beside the glowing bars,
Murmur, a little sadly, how Love fled
And paced upon the mountains overhead
And hid his face amid a crowd of stars. 12

57. The use of more conjunction than is normal in the first line of William Butler Yeats's "When You Are Old" is an example of
- A) asyndeton.
 - B) hendiadys.
 - C) polyhyphenation.
 - D) polyptoton.
 - E) polysyndeton.
58. The imperative verb beginning the lyric poem's line 10 is an example of (a)
- A) amphigory.
 - B) neologism.
 - C) onomatopoeia.
 - D) solecism.
 - E) syzygy.
59. The *abba* rhyme scheme characterizing each stanza of Yeats's poem is known as
- A) chain rhyme.
 - B) compound rhyme.
 - C) enclosed rhyme.
 - D) leonine rhyme.
 - E) mosaic rhyme.
60. The speaker's telling his listener that "Love fled / And paced [. . .] / And hid his face" (lines 10-12), thus treating an abstraction as a concrete thing, as though Love has concrete form, is an instance of
- A) anthropomorphism.
 - B) apostrophe.
 - C) kenosis.
 - D) prosopopoeia.
 - E) reification.

Items 61-65 refer to Ralph Waldo Emerson's

Brahma

If the red slayer think he slays,
Or if the slain think he is slain,
They know not well the subtle ways
I keep, and pass, and turn again. 4

Far or forgot to me is near;
Shadow and sunlight are the same;
The vanished gods to me appear;
And one to me are shame and fame. 8

They reckon ill who leave me out;
When me they fly, I am the wings;
I am the doubter and the doubt,
I am the hymn the Brahmin sings. 12

The strong gods pine for my abode,
And pine in vain the sacred Seven;
But thou, meek lover of the good!
Find me, and turn thy back on heaven. 16

—Brahma is the Hindu god of creation
—Brahma is the speaker in the poem
—the red slayer is any entity that kills
—the sacred Seven are holy persons
—Brahmins are a Hindu caste

61. The repetition of beginning words in lines 11 and 12 of Emerson's "Brahma" is known as
- A) anaphora.
 - B) epanalepsis.
 - C) homeoteleuton.
 - D) parataxis.
 - E) polyptoton.
62. The type of end rhyme found in the pairing of lines 14 and 16 is
- A) broken rhyme.
 - B) feminine rhyme.
 - C) masculine rhyme.
 - D) oblique rhyme.
 - E) slant rhyme.
63. The unusual placement of sentence elements in an order that accommodates both rhyme and rhythm as found in "And pine in vain the sacred Seven" (line 14) is called
- A) accentualism.
 - B) inversion.
 - C) litotes.
 - D) metathesis.
 - E) paragoge.

64. The melopoeic device overwhelmingly characterizing many lines in Emerson's poem is
- A) alliteration.
 - B) colliteration.
 - C) dissonance.
 - D) onomatopoeia.
 - E) resonance.
65. The type of rhyme found within lines 1, 2, 8, 10, 11, 14, and 16 is
- A) broken rhyme.
 - B) compound rhyme.
 - C) leonine rhyme.
 - D) heteromorous rhyme.
 - E) internal rhyme.

Required Tie-Breaking Essay

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook's* notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Elizabeth Barrett Browning's "The Poet," and address the speaker's notion that poets have been set in our midst (line 12) for a specific purpose.

The Poet

The poet hath the child's sight in his breast, And sees all <i>new</i>. What oftenest he has viewed, He views with the first glory. Fair and good Pall* never on him, at the fairest, best, But stand before him holy and undressed In week-day false conventions, such as would Drag other men down from the altitude Of primal types, too early dispossessed. Why,* God would tire of all his heavens, as soon As thou, O godlike, childlike poet, didst, Of daily and nightly sights of sun and moon! And therefore hath he set thee in the midst, Where men may hear thy wonder's ceaseless tune And praise his world forever, as thou bidst.	4 8 12	*become boring *read as "Then"
---	-----------------------------	--

DO NOT DISTRIBUTE THIS **KEY** TO STUDENTS BEFORE OR DURING THE CONTEST.

**UIL Literary Criticism
District • 2022**

line arrows up ➔

1.	C	84
2.	E	357
3.	D	600
4.	B	226
5.	B	168
6.	A	96
7.	E	492
8.	B	19; 358
9.	A	50
10.	D	
11.	E	497
12.	D	607
13.	C	269
14.	D	401
15.	A	219
16.	A	563
17.	D	456
18.	D	576
19.	E	561
20.	C	299
21.	E	472
22.	B	265
23.	D	315
24.	D	409
25.	A	546
26.	C	250
27.	C	253
28.	B	132
29.	E	603
30.	A	10

31.	A	1.3.134
32.	B	5.3.75
33.	A	3.4.28
34.	E	4.1.119
35.	D	4.3.215
36.	C	2.2.78
37.	C	33 ^(32&38)
38.	B	2
39.	E	176
40.	B	108
41.	C	71; 345
42.	B	48
43.	D	
44.	E	
45.	D	469
46.	C	174
47.	A	34
48.	D	300
49.	A	107
50.	C	
51.	D	442
52.	E	356
53.	B	33
54.	C	337
55.	A	177
56.	B	84
57.	E	373
58.	C	337
59.	C	170
60.	E	405
61.	A	24
62.	B	196
63.	B	257
64.	A	13
65.	E	255

FOLD

along the **three**
longitudinal
lines for ease
in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective
scores should not be altered to
reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1
are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2
are worth two points each.

DO NOT
mark (cross out)
actual **LETTER** answer;
mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer
to the *Handbook 12e*,

Folger Shakespeare
The Tragedy of Macbeth,

Scribner
The Great Gatsby,
and

Mint Editions
Sonnets from the Portuguese
and Reading List addendum

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

- the degree to which the instructions have been followed,
- the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,
- the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and
- the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Elizabeth Barrett Browning's "The Poet"

Literary concepts that **MIGHT** be used by the contestant in a discussion of Elizabeth Barrett Browning's notion that poets have been set in our midst for a specific purpose include

alliteration,	metonymy,
anthropomorphism,	octave,
apostrophe,	polyptoton,
archaism,	rhyme scheme,
chiasmus,	sestet,
controlling image,	simile,
enclosed rhyme,	sonnet,
iambic pentameter,	speaker,
imagery,	syzygy,
internal rhyme,	theme,
inversion,	tone, and
meter,	volta.

The contestant might recognize that Browning's foundational comparisons—godlike and childlike, a pairing of similes following the volta "Why" (read as "then") offer a focus for the speaker's argument that poets exist among us for a specific purpose, that purpose being to alert us to the beauty of the everyday world. (making the familiar unfamiliar)

The sonnet's argument that the poet is childlike in her recognition of beauty, that she sees everything as if seeing it for the first time (lines 1-3) and is thus godlike in recognizing the beauty: God, the argument infers, "would tire" of what is oftenest viewed (line 2) were he like ordinary men "too early dispossessed" (line 8) of wonderment.

The young critic should find in the sonnet's last two lines (as is with many sonnets) a summing up of the sonnet's argument, which points to the poet's specific purpose. The poets in our midst are to write memorable poetry—the ceaseless-tunes—that draw attention—praise—to the world's beauty.